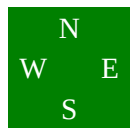


Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 7
♥ K 6 5 2
♦ K Q 9
♣ 10 7 4 2

♠ A K 6 3
♥ A Q
♦ A 10 7 5
♣ A 8 3



♠ Q J 10 5 2
♥ 8 4
♦ J 8 3
♣ Q 9 6

♠ 8 4
♥ J 10 9 7 3
♦ 6 4 2
♣ K J 5

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

You don't have the entries to think about going over to dummy to finesse the ♥K, so you play the ♥A then the ♥Q, hoping a defender will grab their ♥K and set up three ♥ winners in dummy.

But they allow your ♥Q to hold the trick.

Now you are desperate. You need two entries to dummy, one so you can play ♥s to force out the ♥Q, and another to enjoy the good ♥s. One of these entries will be the ♣K and the second will have to be the ♣J. So you play a ♣ to the Jack and then you . . .

. . .

Lucky you. East held the ♣Q.

But don't get too smug. A lot of the plays work in these practice deals because they are set up to reward the correct Plan. In real life finesses only work half the time.

Partner's 3♦ bid is a transfer; you dutifully reply 3♥. Partner now bids 3NT.

Partner has just a 5-card ♥ suit. He doesn't have 4 ♠s or he would have used Stayman.

With no 8-card Major fit you pass 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠Q on which West plays the ♠7.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 6

You might get one more winner from the ♣ finesse, but basically you are going to have to establish dummy's ♥s.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 4 2
♥ A Q J 10 6 3
♦ 5 4
♣ 7 3

♠ K 9 8 3
♥ 4
♦ Q 9 6
♣ K 9 8 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 5
♥ 7 5
♦ A K 7 3
♣ A J 4 2

♠ Q 10 7
♥ K 9 8 2
♦ J 10 8 2
♣ Q 10

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by East hand.			

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. With 6 ♥s you transfer partner by bidding 2♦. Partner replies 2♥.

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. With 6 ♥s you transfer partner by bidding 2♦. Partner replies 2♥.

Remember, you have invitational strength, so even with a great trump suit you bid just 3♥. Partner puts it in game at 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by West.

East plays 4♥. South leads the ♦J and North plays the ♦9.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4 Losers are as seen from dummy, the long-trump

You might get lucky in one of the black suits, but your best hope is that South holds the ♥K.

You win the first ♦ and play a ♥ to dummy's ♥10, which wins the trick. You smile. Return to your hand with the other ♦, then play your last ♥ to dummy's ♥J, which wins the trick. But this time you don't smile because North discards! South still holds ♥K 9 and you have no more ♥s to lead for a finesse. Does that finish you?

Never say die. Return to your hand with a black Ace and ruff a ♦ in dummy. Dummy's trumps are now ♥A Q 6 and South still has ♥K 9.

Back to your hand with the other black Ace and ruff another ♦ in dummy. Dummy's trumps are now ♥A Q and South still has ♥K 9. Play any black card from dummy, then sit back and wait for your two trump tricks!

Bad trump splits can sometimes be countered by a technique called a trump coup.

The coup is accomplished by ruffing to shorten the trump holding so you won't have to play trumps from that holding.

Pretty much like this hand.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 4
♥ 9 8 6 2
♦ 5 4
♣ 8 5 3

♠ A 6 3

♥ K Q 7 3

♦ Q 8 7

♣ J 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5 2

♥ J 10 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ Q 10 9 4

♠ J 9 7

♥ A 5

♦ A K J 10 3

♣ A K 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	4NT	Pass	2NT
All Pass			6NT

6NT by South

know West holds ♠Q). In fact, you should even give him some incentive to play another ♠ by dropping your ♠9, pretending to hold just the ♠ J 9. But West noticed his partner's discouraging ♠2 and switched to the ♣8.

You try the ♣J but East plays the ♣Q and you have to win with your ♣K.

Your chances for success are slipping away and you are down to your last hope. Your ♠J is a threat that only West can guard against. If West also is the defender with long ♥s then he would also have to guard dummy's fourth ♥. In that case you could squeeze him. But there is one important play you must make for the squeeze to function.

You must play dummy's ♠A to unblock so your ♠J can be the threat you need. Then play the ♥A, ♣A and 5 ♦ winners.

If West has thrown the ♠Q you win your ♠J and dummy's two high ♥s. But since he probably held onto the ♠Q you just play a ♥ to dummy and hope all three ♥s are winners.

Since West had to guard both the ♥s and your ♠J, he was unable to do both, and the squeeze worked.

You were lucky it wasn't East with the 4 ♥s.

Because of his 3-4-3-3 distribution, partner chose not to look for a ♥ fit. If he had opted for Stayman the contract would have turned out the same. The 4NT response is quantitative, inviting you to bid 6NT if you have a maximum.

You do. 6NT.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠K. You will have to make an early decision on whether to hold up or not.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 5 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 11

Only one more winner is needed. You should play a low ♠ from dummy in the hope that West will lead the suit again, giving you a trick with your ♠J (you